MEMO

To: All volunteers
From: The board
Date: 30 October 2026

Most entries are short. Wind from the south-west, fresh; visibility good; two steamers northbound before midnight. But every few pages the keeper allowed himself a sentence more, and those sentences are the reason people still read the logs today.

In the winter of 1893 the ice reached the outer skerries, something no one in the village had seen before. The keeper walked across to the nearest island with his son, measured the ice with an auger and wrote that it was thicker than the kitchen table and twice as level.

Please note that the **winter schedule** starts on 1 November.

Daily life followed the light. The lamp was trimmed at dusk and dawn, the lens polished every morning, and the brass fittings once a week whether they needed it or not. Supplies came by boat every second Thursday, weather permitting, which in February it rarely did.

When the light was automated in 1968 the last keeper moved to a house in the village from which, on clear nights, he could see the beam sweep past his window every twelve seconds. He kept writing the log for another two years, out of habit.

The transcription project took four years and relied almost entirely on volunteers. Handwriting changed from keeper to keeper, abbreviations drifted, and the ink of the earliest volumes had faded to the colour of weak tea, so every page was read twice by different people.